Diagnosing the pipeline

Complete text version

Your manager has supplied a reference report and three pipelines to review. Compare each report with example A, identify a supported strength and a risk, and decide whether it needs attention in this exercise.

This is ungraded practice with fictional reports. The checks assess your selected evidence, not your optional written explanation. Your work and checked attempts are saved automatically in this browser. Return here to resume; Restart clears saved work and attempts for this activity. Nothing is submitted. Download your review if you want to keep it.

Definitions and example

Report A is the supplied healthy example for this exercise. Its records have 3, 5, 7, 6 and 4 days in their respective stages; close probability estimates rise from 20% at Prospect to 90% at Close.

Each report contains one opportunity in each of five work stages. Counts therefore do not establish a large backlog, measured conversion rate or movement over time. Compare the supplied time-in-stage and probability patterns instead.

Use A as a comparison, not a universal stage-duration target. An ageing difference suggests a question to investigate; the report does not establish its cause or prove an opportunity is lost.

Close probability is the supplied estimate for each opportunity, not a measured conversion rate. Forecasted revenue here is deal value multiplied by that estimate; it is not guaranteed revenue. Values use a common monetary unit.

No sales target or reporting period is supplied. The reports do not establish target coverage or realised sales performance. A Close work stage is distinct from an outcome such as Closed Won.

Using this text version

Read example A and note the characteristics you would use for comparison. For B, C and D, compare each work stage with A using days in stage, supplied close probability and forecasted revenue. Choose a diagnosis, one supported strength and one supported risk, then add your own reasoning or a question to investigate. Make your choices before reading feedback. No spreadsheet application is needed.

In the interaction, the metric control switches between Days in stage, Close probability (%) and Forecasted revenue (units, estimate). Compare with example A adds or removes a second, labelled bar per stage. Every bar also has its numeric value in text. Open the five report records shows all data columns below. The same records are provided here in full.

Check my diagnosis explains each chosen answer. After two unsuccessful checks, Show a worked diagnosis fills supported choices; select Complete this review to finish. Nothing advances automatically. Changing an answer invalidates its check and completion, so check it again. Complete all three report reviews before opening the final record. Worked diagnoses are recorded separately from checked choices. Optional personal notes are not automatically assessed or submitted.

Report A - supplied example

- A-OPP1 | Jin Cloud Solutions | Work stage: Prospect | Days in stage: 3 | Deal value: 15,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 20% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 3,000 monetary units.
- A-OPP2 | Ordinary Systems | Work stage: Qualify | Days in stage: 5 | Deal value: 16,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 40% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 6,400 monetary units.
- A-OPP3 | Solitude Innovations | Work stage: Discover | Days in stage: 7 | Deal value: 17,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 55% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 9,350 monetary units.
- A-OPP4 | Patternmaster Strategies | Work stage: Propose | Days in stage: 6 | Deal value: 18,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 70% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 12,600 monetary units.
- A-OPP5 | Carrow and Vale Consulting | Work stage: Close | Days in stage: 4 | Deal value: 20,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 90% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 18,000 monetary units.

What the example shows

A has one record per stage. Its supplied probability estimates increase from 20% to 90%, with stage durations of 3, 5, 7, 6 and 4 days. These are useful reference values. The snapshot does not prove steady movement, measured conversion or sales-target attainment.

Which characteristics would you use as a comparison? Optional personal notes.

Report B

- B-OPP1 | Ashbourne Global | Work stage: Prospect | Days in stage: 12 | Deal value: 14,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 20% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 2,800 monetary units.
- B-OPP2 | Anarres Systems | Work stage: Qualify | Days in stage: 20 | Deal value: 15,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 25% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 3,750 monetary units.
- B-OPP3 | Port Coriol Labs | Work stage: Discover | Days in stage: 15 | Deal value: 16,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 30% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 4,800 monetary units.
- B-OPP4 | Lancre Works | Work stage: Propose | Days in stage: 10 | Deal value: 17,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 35% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 5,950 monetary units.
- B-OPP5 | Dawnstar Diagnostics | Work stage: Close | Days in stage: 9 | Deal value: 18,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 50% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 9,000 monetary units.

Choose before reading feedback

Your diagnosis for this exercise

- At risk: investigate the ageing pattern
- Healthy: no further investigation is needed

A strength supported by B's data

- Close probability estimates increase from 20% at Prospect to 50% at Close.
- B has a larger early-stage opportunity volume than A.
- The Close record proves B has already won the sale.

The evidence that most clearly warrants attention

- Qualify has 20 days in B versus 5 in A; B's other stage times are also higher.
- There are no records in B's Propose stage.
- The 20-day qualification record is definitely lost.
- B has breached a universal ten-day qualification target.

Your reasoning or follow-up question (optional; not automatically assessed).

Feedback: compare after choosing

Your diagnosis for this exercise

At risk: investigate the ageing pattern Compared with example A, B has longer times in every stage, including 20 days in Qualify versus 5. That supports a timing concern, without proving a stall or its cause.

Healthy: no further investigation is needed B's qualification record has 20 days in stage versus 5 in A. The larger timing values deserve investigation even though some probability estimates rise in later stages.

A strength supported by B's data

Close probability estimates increase from 20% at Prospect to 50% at Close. The supplied estimates are 20%, 25%, 30%, 35% and 50% across B's stages. That increasing pattern is a relative strength; it does not establish actual conversion.

B has a larger early-stage opportunity volume than A. Both reports have one opportunity in each stage. The displayed counts do not support a larger-volume claim.

The Close record proves B has already won the sale. Close is the work stage shown. No completed purchase outcome is supplied.

The evidence that most clearly warrants attention

Qualify has 20 days in B versus 5 in A; B's other stage times are also higher. B's days are 12, 20, 15, 10 and 9 versus A's 3, 5, 7, 6 and 4. Qualification is the largest gap, suggesting a useful starting point for review.

There are no records in B's Propose stage. B-OPP4 is in Propose, with 10 days and a 35% close probability estimate.

The 20-day qualification record is definitely lost. The record still says Qualify. Duration does not establish a loss or a reason to change its outcome.

B has breached a universal ten-day qualification target. No ten-day target is supplied. Compare B with the exercise's reference without inventing a universal rule.

Worked diagnosis

Your diagnosis for this exercise: At risk: investigate the ageing pattern

A strength supported by B's data: Close probability estimates increase from 20% at Prospect to 50% at Close.

The evidence that most clearly warrants attention: Qualify has 20 days in B versus 5 in A; B's other stage times are also higher.

Report C

- C-OPP1 | Primer Systems | Work stage: Prospect | Days in stage: 4 | Deal value: 15,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 30% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 4,500 monetary units.
- C-OPP2 | Makeda MedTech | Work stage: Qualify | Days in stage: 6 | Deal value: 16,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 40% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 6,400 monetary units.
- C-OPP3 | Karhide Consulting Group | Work stage: Discover | Days in stage: 8 | Deal value: 17,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 50% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 8,500 monetary units.
- C-OPP4 | Olamina Advisory | Work stage: Propose | Days in stage: 12 | Deal value: 18,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 40% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 7,200 monetary units.
- C-OPP5 | Vetinari Investments | Work stage: Close | Days in stage: 14 | Deal value: 20,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 35% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 7,000 monetary units.

Choose before reading feedback

Your diagnosis for this exercise

- At risk: investigate the later-stage estimates and ageing
- Healthy: the later-stage pattern needs no attention

A strength supported by C's data

- The estimate rises from 30% at Prospect to 50% at Discover.
- Every forecasted value is guaranteed revenue.
- Close has C's highest probability estimate.

The evidence that most clearly warrants attention

- Discover to Close: probability 50% to 35%, forecast 8,500 to 7,000, and days 8 to 14.
- The number of Close opportunities collapses relative to Discover.
- The data proves the seller failed in negotiation.
- Propose-to-Close forecast falls from 7,200 to zero.

Your reasoning or follow-up question (optional; not automatically assessed).

Feedback: compare after choosing

Your diagnosis for this exercise

At risk: investigate the later-stage estimates and ageing C's close probability estimate falls from 50% at Discover to 40% at Propose and 35% at Close, while days increase from 8 to 12 and 14. That combination warrants investigation.

Healthy: the later-stage pattern needs no attention The probability estimates fall through C's later stages as time in stage rises. Compare that pattern with A's increasing later-stage estimates and shorter later-stage durations.

A strength supported by C's data

The estimate rises from 30% at Prospect to 50% at Discover. C's early-stage estimates are 30%, 40% and 50%. That early pattern is a relative strength alongside the later-stage concern.

Every forecasted value is guaranteed revenue. Forecasted revenue uses supplied probability estimates. It does not establish a commitment or a completed sale.

Close has C's highest probability estimate. C's Close estimate is 35%; Discover is 50%. A later stage does not automatically have a higher supplied estimate.

The evidence that most clearly warrants attention

Discover to Close: probability 50% to 35%, forecast 8,500 to 7,000, and days 8 to 14. Those are the displayed values. The Propose-to-Close change alone is 40% to 35% and 7,200 to 7,000; describe its size accurately and review it with the ageing pattern.

The number of Close opportunities collapses relative to Discover. C has one opportunity in each stage. These counts do not establish a volume collapse or a measured conversion decline.

The data proves the seller failed in negotiation. The estimates and ageing suggest a review, but no negotiation record or causal evidence is supplied.

Propose-to-Close forecast falls from 7,200 to zero. C's Close forecast is 7,000. Use the actual 7,200-to-7,000 change instead of overstating it.

Worked diagnosis

Your diagnosis for this exercise: At risk: investigate the later-stage estimates and ageing

A strength supported by C's data: The estimate rises from 30% at Prospect to 50% at Discover.

The evidence that most clearly warrants attention: Discover to Close: probability 50% to 35%, forecast 8,500 to 7,000, and days 8 to 14.

Report D

- D-OPP1 | Klatch Mercantile | Work stage: Prospect | Days in stage: 20 | Deal value: 15,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 15% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 2,250 monetary units.
- D-OPP2 | Sto Lat Select | Work stage: Qualify | Days in stage: 12 | Deal value: 16,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 25% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 4,000 monetary units.
- D-OPP3 | Silverpath Outfitters | Work stage: Discover | Days in stage: 14 | Deal value: 17,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 30% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 5,100 monetary units.
- D-OPP4 | Laconia Energy Systems | Work stage: Propose | Days in stage: 8 | Deal value: 18,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 60% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 10,800 monetary units.
- D-OPP5 | Idiran Dynamics | Work stage: Close | Days in stage: 7 | Deal value: 20,000 monetary units | Close probability estimate: 75% | Forecasted revenue estimate: 15,000 monetary units.

Choose before reading feedback

Your diagnosis for this exercise

- At risk: investigate early-stage ageing despite stronger later estimates
- Healthy: later estimates make early-stage ageing irrelevant

A strength supported by D's data

- Later close probability estimates reach 60% at Propose and 75% at Close.
- D is faster than A in every stage.
- D's forecast proves the sales target has been met.

The evidence that most clearly warrants attention

- Prospect has 20 days versus A's 3; Discover has 14 versus A's 7.
- D's Close probability estimate is only 15%.
- D has more Prospect records than all other stages combined.
- All D opportunities have failed because they are older than A's.

Your reasoning or follow-up question (optional; not automatically assessed).

Feedback: compare after choosing

Your diagnosis for this exercise

At risk: investigate early-stage ageing despite stronger later estimates D has 20 days in Prospect and 14 in Discover, versus A's 3 and 7. Later estimates of 60% and 75% are a strength, but do not remove the early-stage timing concern.

Healthy: later estimates make early-stage ageing irrelevant The later estimates do not explain D's 20-day Prospect and 14-day Discover records. Review both the strength and the timing concern.

A strength supported by D's data

Later close probability estimates reach 60% at Propose and 75% at Close. Those later estimates are higher than D's early estimates of 15%, 25% and 30%. They remain estimates, not completed outcomes.

D is faster than A in every stage. D has more days in every stage than A. Its Prospect record is 20 days versus 3 in A.

D's forecast proves the sales target has been met. No sales target is supplied, and forecasted revenue is not realised revenue.

The evidence that most clearly warrants attention

Prospect has 20 days versus A's 3; Discover has 14 versus A's 7. Those early-stage differences warrant investigating what is holding up each opportunity. They do not establish a large-volume backlog or its cause.

D's Close probability estimate is only 15%. 15% belongs to Prospect. The Close estimate is 75%; match each value to its actual stage.

D has more Prospect records than all other stages combined. There is one D record in each stage. The available data supports an ageing comparison, not this volume claim.

All D opportunities have failed because they are older than A's. Longer time supports investigation. It does not establish a loss for every opportunity.

Worked diagnosis

Your diagnosis for this exercise: At risk: investigate early-stage ageing despite stronger later estimates

A strength supported by D's data: Later close probability estimates reach 60% at Propose and 75% at Close.

The evidence that most clearly warrants attention: Prospect has 20 days versus A's 3; Discover has 14 versus A's 7.

Your diagnostic review

Keep your observations about A, the diagnosis/strength/risk for each of B, C and D, and your optional reasoning. The interaction downloads these as a text file; open it in a text editor and save it before reloading. Choose a diagnosis, a supported strength and a supported risk before checking. An incomplete report remains labelled This report review is not complete yet. Start again clears all answers, notes, completion stamps and progress.

Keep your diagnosis tied to the metric and stage you observed. Decide what you would investigate before changing an opportunity's status. Return to the course page to mark this step complete; this activity does not update FutureLearn completion.